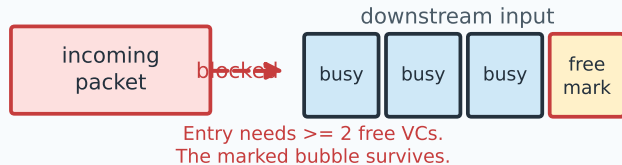


# Critical Bubble Scheme: preserve one movable empty slot

A marked free VC is protected at ring entry and relocates after in-ring transit.

## 1. External entry at the marked port

One free VC remains: block the new packet.



## 2. In-ring transit across the marked port

A packet advances; its vacated upstream slot becomes the new mark.

